

Oxygen Devices and Checks

Know the device family, assess the client, and never substitute a memorized flow range for the order and policy.

Common families - Nasal cannula: low-flow, allows talking/eating. - Simple or reservoir masks: fit and minimum-flow safety matter. - Venturi-style mask: controlled oxygen concentration. - High-flow systems: heated/humidified support with specific equipment.	Nursing checks - Airway, work of breathing, speech, mental status, color, and trend. - Correct device, fit, setting, tubing, humidification, and skin protection. - Fire safety and no petroleum-based products.
Escalate - New severe distress, cyanosis, reduced consciousness, silent chest, stridor, or unexpected deterioration. - Do not delay help while troubleshooting equipment. - Follow the prescribed target and protocol.	